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August 4, 1978
SUPERSEDING
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September 27, 1976

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TABLECLOTH AND NAPKIN, TABLE, TEXTILE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for cotton or cotton/polyester blended damask and momie tablecloths and napkins.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type. The tablecloth and napkin covered by this specification shall be white and of two types.

Type I - Damask.
Type II - Momie cloth.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7210

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Laws and Regulations:

16 CFR 303 - Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Fiber. The cotton fiber or blend of cotton/polyester fiber shall be of a suitable staple length and grade to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.1.1.1 Yarn. The yarn shall be made from either 100 percent cotton or a blend of cotton and polyester fiber containing not less than 50 percent cotton. The cotton shall be cleaned, carded and combed, drawn and evenly spun into yarn with sufficient twist to meet the requirements of this specification when tested as specified in 4.3 and table IV.

3.1.1.2 Weave. The cloth for type I shall be a damask weave of five leaf or fleur-de-lis twill construction. The cloth for type II shall be a momie weave construction (see 6.3 and 6.4).

3.1.1.3 Finish. The cloth shall be bleached and mercerized in accordance with normal commercial practice providing a clear lustrous finish. The total sizing, finishing, and other nonfibrous material content of the finished cotton or cotton/-polyester blend shall not exceed 5.0 percent when tested as specified in 4.3. The finished cloth shall not lint, and shall retain its original luster and body after laundering when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.1.1.4 Shrinkage. The finished cloth shall not shrink more than 6.0 percent in either the direction of the warp or the filling when tested as specified in 4.3.

3.1.1.5 Physical requirements. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements shown in table I when tested as specified in 4.3.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Material	Wt. oz per sq yd (min.)	Yarns per inch 1/		Breaking strength lb (min.)	
		Warp	Filling	Warp	Filling
Type I	5.5	78	52	67	74
Type II	5.5	60	56	70	75

1/ A minus tolerance of 4 yarns (total of warp and filling) and any plus tolerance will be permitted.

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3.1.2 Thread. Thread for seaming and stitching shall be white and either mercerized cotton or a blend of polyester/cotton with sufficient breaking strength and quality to meet the needs of its intended application.

3.2 Construction. The tablecloth and napkin shall be fabricated in one piece from the cloth specified in 3.1. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the tablecloth shall have a straight woven selvage on each side with cut ends finished with a 1/4 inch hem as specified in 3.2.1. The napkin shall have each side finished with either a 1/4 inch hem as specified in 3.2.1 and/or a straight woven selvage.

3.2.1 Stitching. Using commercially standard stitching, hemming operations shall be conducted with not less than nine stitches per inch. Ends of seams and stitching, when not caught in seams or stitching, shall be backstitched.

3.3 Size.

3.3.1 Tablecloth. The sizes of the tablecloth are listed in table II. The size to be procured shall be as specified (see 6.2). The diagonal measurements of the tablecloth shall be equal to each other within 3 inches.

TABLE II. Tablecloth sizes

Finished width 1/	Finished length
54	54
54	72
54	96
64	64
72	72
72	90

1/ Inclusive of selvage.

3.3.2 Napkins. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the damask napkins shall be 22 x 22 inches and the momie napkins shall be 21 x 21 inches when finished. The diagonal measurements of the napkin shall be equal to each other within 1/2 inch.

3.3.3 Tolerances. A minus 1/2 inch or plus 4 percent tolerance both for length and width for tablecloths will be permitted. A minus tolerance of 1/4 inch and a plus tolerance of 1/2 inch for length and width for napkins will be permitted.

3.4 Fiber identification. Each tablecloth and napkin shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.5 Workmanship. Tablecloths and napkins shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Examination of the end item. The tablecloths and napkins shall be inspected to determine conformance with the requirements of this specification. Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with table III. The sample unit for this examination shall be one tablecloth or napkin. The acceptable quality levels shall be 4.0 percent defective, using inspection level S-3.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Material	Cut, hole or tear. Weave, not as specified. Smash.
	Broken or missing yarns.
	Slubs, slugs, slough-off, or jerked-in filling.
	Floats or skips.
Hems	Any required hem omitted.
	Any hem twisted, puckered, badly pleated or not uniform in width, affecting appearance.
	Backstitching, as required, omitted.
	Construction not as specified.
	Loose stitch tension, resulting in loosely secured hem.

4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The tablecloths and napkins shall be examined for defects in dimensions. The inspection level shall be S-2. Sample unit shall be as specified in 4.2.1. Any dimension of the end item not in conformance with dimensions, including tolerances, specified herein shall be classified as a defect. The acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

4.3 Testing of the end item. Tests shall be performed for the characteristics specified in table IV. The methods of testing shall be as specified in Fed. Test Method Std. 191. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using a special inspection level of S-1 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be two tablecloths or five napkins.

TABLE IV. Tests

Examine	Requirement reference	Test method	No. determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Identification of fiber (cotton)	3.1.1.1	1200	-	pass or fail
Identification of fiber (polyester)	3.1.1.1	2535	-	pass or fail
Nonfibrous materials	3.1.1.3	2611	2	0.1 percent
Linting, luster and body after laundering	3.1.1.3	4.4	3 warp, 3 fill	0.1 percent
Shrinkage	3.1.1.4	5550	3	0.1 percent
Weight, oz sq. yard	Table I	4.5	5	0.1 ounce
Yarns per inch	Table I	5050	1 warp, 5 filling	pass or fail
Breaking strength	Table I	5100	5	1.0 pound

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4.4 Linting, luster and body after laundering. The tablecloth or napkin shall be subjected to three washing cycles, extractions, dryings, and pressings in accordance with paragraphs 4.1 through 4.2 of method 5550 in Fed. Std. No. 191, after which the sample shall be examined to determine conformance with requirements concerning linting, luster and body in paragraph 3.1.1.3.

4.5 Weight per square yard. The specimen shall be a piece of material not less than 6 square inches in area, cleanly cut from the sample material. No selvages or seams shall be included in the samples cut. Five specimens shall be chosen randomly from each sample. A direct reading balance, calibrated to give the weight in ounces per square yard and accurate to the nearest 0.05 ounce, may be used. Otherwise, the specimen shall be weighed to the nearest 0.01 gram on an analytical balance to calculate the weight per square yard using the following equation:

$$\text{Wt. per sq yd, oz} = \frac{\text{Wt. of specimen in gm} \times 36 \text{ in/yd} \times 36 \text{ in/yd}}{\text{Area of specimen in sq in} \times 28.5 \text{ gm/oz}}$$

The weight of the sample unit shall be the average of the results obtained from the specimens tested.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.1.1.1 Tablecloth. Each tablecloth, compactly folded, shall be packaged in a close-fitting polyethylene bag. The bag shall be sealed.

5.1.1.1.2 Napkin. Twelve napkins, each compactly folded, shall be wrapped with paper and secured with tape. Alternatively, the napkins shall be packaged in a close-fitting polyethylene bag. The bag shall be sealed.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twelve packages of tablecloths, of like description, in sizes 64 x 64 and smaller, or six packages in sizes larger than 64 x 64, shall be intermediate packaged in a close-fitting fiberboard box, class domestic.

5.1.2 Commercial. Each tablecloth or napkin shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. The tablecloths or napkins, of like description, in quantities as specified (see 6.1), shall be packed in a close-fitting weather-resistant fiberboard box. The box shall be waterproofed sealed with tape and reinforced with strapping or filament reinforced, pressure sensitive adhesive tape.

5.2.2 Commercial. The packaged tablecloth or napkins shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to insure delivery at destination, to provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tablecloth is used for covering a dining table before tableware is placed. The napkin is used for protecting the diners' clothing.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select he preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Construction of sides and ends if other than specified (see 3.2).
(d) Size required for tablecloth and napkin, if other than specified (see 3.3.1 and 3.3.2).
(e) Packaging shall be level A or Commercial (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2).

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6.3 Momie weave. Momie weave, sometimes called granite weave, is a broad classification of weaves producing an irregular pebbled effect similar to crepe. These weaves may be a satin, twill or other regular weave plan arranged to produce tightly interlaced warp and filling yarns on the face of the fabric without showing twill lines.

6.4 Damask weave. A jacquard woven fabric with elaborate floral or geometric patterns formed by warp satin weave floats over a background of filling satin weave.

Five leaf. A design including leaves or a combination of leaves and vines.
Fleur-de-lis. A heraldic design somewhat resembling three petals or floral segments of an iris tied by an encircling band.

MILITARY INTEREST:

DOD has waived coordination on revisions and amendment to this federal specification until further notice.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

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